

1. Why I don't like the "staff engineer archetypes"

Source: seangoedecke.com RSS feed | Published: Sun, 03 May 2026 00:00:00 GMT

Link: <https://seangoedecke.com/staff-engineer-archetypes/>

The most influential piece of writing about staff engineers in the last decade has to be Will Larson's Staff engineer archetypes . He argues that the "staff engineer" title covers at least four very different roles: the team lead, the architect, the solver, and the right hand. This taxonomy gets cited a lot as advice for people who are trying to become effective staff engineers. For both of my promotions to staff engineer, my manager at the time linked me to the "staff engineer archetypes" and asked me to consider which of these archetypes I was aiming towards. These archetypes definitely exist 1 . However, I think it's bad practical advice to tell engineers to try and target them. Archetypes do not make good goals To see why, let's take the "team lead" archetype. Larson describes this as an informal technical leadership role: not necessarily an explicit authority figure, but someone who's good at scoping work, planning projects, and maintaining the kind of relationships (e.g. with other teams) needed to successfully ship . If you want to fill this role, shouldn't you start trying to do these things? No! You don't become a technical leader by trying really hard to be a technical l...

2. X, the Platform of Free Speech

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-05-04T00:15:21Z

Link: <https://bsky.app/profile/gilduran.com/post/3mky5taqg3222>

Gil Duran, posting on Bluesky: It's official! I'm permanently banned from X for tweeting "TLDR: Fascism." (appeal denied) "TLDR: Fascism" was Duran's two-word response to this 1,000-word essay from Palantir describing their vision for a "Technological Republic". (Alternative link to essay if you don't want to visit x.com.) Getting perma-banned from Twitter/X by Elon Musk gives Duran a nice Streisand-effect boost to promote his upcoming new book, The Nerd Reich . If the book is even half as good as its title it should be a bestseller. ?

3. "2 Letters From Steve"

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-05-03T23:47:11Z

Link: <https://davidgelphman.wordpress.com/2013/03/29/2-letters-from-steve/>

I don't want to spoil any of this story from David Gelphman, which he wrote back in 2013, but which I only came across this week. Go read it. But before you do, one bit of context you should keep in mind is that the original iPad was unveiled at a special Apple event on 27 January 2010 , but it didn't ship until early April . Gelphman's story takes place in that interregnum. ?

4. "Crimes Against Decency Need as Much Cover-Up as Crimes Against the Law"

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-05-03T23:25:41Z

Link: https://daringfireball.net/2026/05/crimes_against_decency_need_as_much_cover-up_as_crimes_against_the_law

There is no point getting any more outraged or disgusted at Meta for firing the Kenyan contractors who exposed the privacy fiasco of AI Glasses than you already were in the first place. They had to fire them.

5. Quoting Anthropic

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-05-03T15:13:23+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/May/3/anthropic/#atom-everything>

We used an automatic classifier which judged sycophancy by looking at whether Claude showed a willingness to push back, maintain positions when challenged, give praise proportional to the merit of ideas, and speak frankly regardless of what a person wants to hear. Most of the time in these situations, Claude expressed no sycophancy?only 9% of conversations included sycophantic behavior (Figure 2). But two domains were exceptions: we saw sycophantic behavior

in 38% of conversations focused on spirituality, and 25% of conversations on relationships. ?
Anthropic , How people ask Claude for personal guidance Tags: ai-ethics , anthropic , claude ,
ai-personality , generative-ai , ai , llms , sycophancy

6. Minimal Viable Zig Error Contexts

Source: matklad | Published: 2026-05-03T00:00:00+00:00

Link: <https://matklad.github.io/2026/05/03/zig-error-context.html>

Out of the box, Zig provides minimal and sufficient facilities for error handling ---
strongly-typed error codes. Error reporting is left to the user. Idiomatic solution is to pass
a `Diagnostics` out parameter (sink) to materialize human-readable strings as needed.

7. The shape of a guitar pick

Source: John D. Cook | Published: Sun, 03 May 2026 20:49:41 +0000

Link: <https://www.johndcook.com/blog/2026/05/03/guitar-pick/>

I saw a post on X that plotted the function $(\log x)^t + (\log y)^t = 1$. Of course the plot of $x^t + y^t = 1$ is a circle, but I never thought what taking logs would do to the shape. Here's what the contours look like setting the right hand side equal to 1, 2, [?] The post The shape of a guitar pick first appeared on John D. Cook .

8. png-cmp: like cmp for PNGs

Source: Evan Hahn (dot com) | Published: Sun, 03 May 2026 00:00:00 +0000

Link: <https://evanhahn.com/png-cmp-is-cmp-but-for-pngs/>

png-cmp is a program I built that checks if two PNGs are visually equivalent. It's inspired by the `cmp` command . Here's how you use it: `png-cmp a.png b.png` Like `cmp` , it silently exits if the images are identical, and gives an error if they're different. Unlike `cmp` , it checks pixel data, not binary data. PNGs can look the same but be stored differently. For example, png-cmp ignores text metadata. I was recently doing an experiment where I wanted to check if two PNGs were visually identical, so I built a tool for it! Grab the source code here.

9. Vertically Aligning Roman Numerals in Code

Source: Terence Eden's Blog | Published: Sun, 03 May 2026 11:34:59 +0000

Link: <https://shkspr.mobi/blog/2026/05/vertically-aligning-roman-numerals-in-code/>

I have a PHP function which uses Roman Numerals. It looks like this: `$romanNumerals = [ "?" => 1000, "???" => 900, "?" => 500, "???" => 400, "?" => 100, "?C" => 90, "?" => 50, "???" => 40, "?" => 10, "?" => 9, "?" => 8, "?" => 7, "?" => 6, "?" => 5, "?" => 4, "?" => 3, "?" => 2, "?" => 1 ]`; The problem is, the?

10. Punk, or why I don't stream anymore

Source: the singularity is nearer | Published: 2026-05-03T00:00:00-07:00

Link: <https://geohot.github.io/blog/jekyll/update/2026/05/03/punk-or-why-i-dont-stream.html>

If you're the sun, I'm a black hole ? The Stephen Hawking, Say Anything What killed the hacker culture I grew up in was spectacle. You can consume it without participating, and even worse it has signaling value. I never did CTFs to put them on my resume. I don't even have a resume I take seriously. Just a battle between me and a machine and the glorification of my ego, sometimes public, but never performative. There was no purpose beyond the thing. The streams by their nature became no longer any truthful reflection of self, just a prediction of what you want on them, and you can't stop this because we are permeable. I've been scraping dating sites and feeding them to ChatGPT, and it's amazing how few of the profiles still say anything about the person. There are no rough edges, it's basically marketing copy. Reflected back and forth in their heads with this ?society? mirror so many times that there's no identity or coherence left, just a mush of diffuse monochrome light. The streams are wireheading, aka ?felt completion without world contact.? You watch and you feel a version of what I feel. But the difference is that you didn't do anything. And in so much as there is a you, it i...

11. QuickQWERTY 1.2.3

Source: Susam Pal | Published: 2026-05-03T00:00:00Z

Link: <https://susam.net/code/news/quickqwerty/1.2.3.html>

QuickQWERTY 1.2.3 is now available. QuickQWERTY is a web-based touch typing tutor for QWERTY keyboards that runs directly in the browser. This release includes two small bug fixes. In the previous release, QuickQWERTY source code management moved from GitHub to Codeberg. During that update, the licence link in the footer was updated incorrectly. The broken licence link has now been fixed. Further, there was a minor bug that caused a redundant dialog box to appear while switching between 6-7 split and 5-6 split. Units 16 to 20 contain two links labeled '6-7 split' and '5-6 split' which allow you to select how you want to split the number keys between left and right hands. Clicking either of those links brings up a dialog that explains what the two splits mean and prompts you to confirm in order to make the switch. Say, the '6-7 split' was already the chosen split. Clicking the '6-7 split' label triggered the dialog box unnecessarily. A dialog was unnecessary in that case since if you were already on the '6-7 split', clicking the '6-7 split' label resulted in no switch. This unnecessary dialog has now been eliminated. To try out QuickQWERTY, please visit quickqwerty.html. The sour...

12. Reinventing the Wheel

Source: Tedium: The Dull Side of the Internet. | Published: 2026-05-03T13:41:32Z

Link: <https://feed.tedium.co/link/15204/17331178/wheel-reinvention-technology-history>

You've probably heard it's futile, but that hasn't stopped plenty from trying some successfully, shockingly.

13. Testing MacOS on the Apple Network Server 2.0 ROMs

Source: Old Vintage Computing Research | Published: 2026-05-02T23:44:00.000-07:00

Link: <https://oldvcr.blogspot.com/2026/05/testing-macos-on-apple-network-server.html>

It's time for another save point in the continuing saga of the various ROMs for the Apple Network Server, Apple's first through-and-through Unix server (previously, previously). The Apple Network Server was only ever officially able to boot AIX, IBM's proprietary Power ISA-specific Unix, though it was originally intended to run Novell NetWare and was demonstrated booting Mac OS with early pre-production ROMs. However, much to industry surprise, late in its life cycle then-CTO Ellen Hancock announced that the ANS would be able to boot Mac OS and even Windows NT as well using ROM upgrades. Neither ROM was officially released before Steve Jobs convinced Gil Amelio to cancel the line, and for many years they were believed to be vapourware. But they've started to surface, first with an ex-Apple employee who had both the preproduction ROM and the Mac OS ROM on a flash ROM SIMM, and later another employee turned up with the NT ROM, though sadly more is needed to make it actually run NT. It turned out that I also had the preproduction ROM in a box gathering dust, and a couple months ago we put both the preproduction ROMs and NT ROMs through their paces. Well, thanks to Jeff Walther w...

14. 29th August 2026: a scenario

Source: Martin Alderson | Published: Mon, 04 May 2026 00:00:00 GMT

Link: https://martinalderson.com/posts/august-29-2026-a-scenario/?utm_source=rss&utm_medium=rss&utm_campaign=feed

A fictional scenario about what AI changes for cloud security, written because the technical version of the argument doesn't land with anyone except engineers.

15. The Genetic Code and Proteins of the Other Covid-19 Vaccines

Source: Bert Hubert's writings | Published: Tue, 12 Jan 2021 13:47:18 +0100

Link: <https://berthub.eu/articles/posts/genetic-code-of-covid-19-vaccines/>

Translations: ??, ??? As a followup to Reverse Engineering the source code of the BioNTech/Pfizer SARS-CoV-2 Vaccine, here is a look at the genetic code behind some of the other vaccines. I recommend at least skimming the earlier post before delving into this one, unless you are already fluent in modified mRNA bases and protein expression mechanics. To get an extremely full background on all vaccine work, I kindly refer you to excellent posts from Derek Lowe and Hilda Bastian.

16. Analiza izvornog kôda vaccine BioNTech-Pfizer SARS-CoV-2

Source: Bert Hubert's writings | Published: Sun, 10 Jan 2021 21:12:20 +0100

Link:

<https://berthub.eu/articles/posts/naliza-izvornog-k%C3%B4da-vaccine-biontech-pfizer-sars-cov-2/>

Translations: ???????? / ????? / ?? (Weixin video, Youtube video) / ?? / bahasa Indonesia / ?eský/ Català/ ?eský/ Deutsch / Espaæol / ?????? / ?????? / Français / ???????? / Hrvatski / Italiano / Nederlands / ??? / ??? 2 / ?????? / Polskie / ???????? / PortuguÆs / Român? / Slovensky / Sloven??ina / Türk / ???????????? / Markdown for translating Dobro do?li! U ovom postu ?emo, znak po znak, ispitati izvorni kôd vaccine mRNA BioNTech / Pfizer SARS-CoV-2.

17. DNA seen through the eyes of a coder (or, If you are a hammer, everything looks like a nail)

Source: Bert Hubert's writings | Published: Sat, 09 Jan 2021 13:33:46 +0000

Link: <https://berthub.eu/articles/posts/amazing-dna/>

Updates: 12th of September 2021: I?m writing a book on DNA! If you want to become a beta reader, or have suggestions, I'd love to hear from you! 8th of January 2021: This article has been revised and updated, scientifically and in terms of dead links. Revision made by TomÆs Simies (@putadagravidade / tomasprsimoos@gmail.com). Feel free to contact me if I made a mistake. 25th of August 2017: This page has led to a two-hour presentation called DNA: The code of Life as presented at SHA 2017.